



GUIDE 05 / POST-INTERVIEW ADMISSIONS SERIES

Japan Student Immigration: Official References

Verified legal and administrative sources for the student, sponsor and agency

Who this is for

Accepted students and partner agencies in Nepal

Osaka Naniwa Japanese Language School

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Reviewed against the supplied school documents and official Japanese government sources. Legal and procedural information checked 28 August 2026.

OFFICIAL SOURCES REVIEWED 28 AUGUST 2026

How to Read This Reference

This guide separates three types of requirements: Japanese law or national administrative rules, current visa or local procedures, and Osaka Naniwa Japanese Language School's own submission standards. Official requirements can change, and immigration authorities may request additional evidence in an individual case.

Not legal advice

This is a practical English summary of official sources. For a disputed, refused or unusually complex case, obtain advice from the school, the Immigration Services Agency, the Embassy/VFS or a qualified Japanese immigration professional.

Topic	Controlling source
COE and Student status	Immigration Services Agency of Japan (ISA)
Visa issuance in Nepal	Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Embassy of Japan in Nepal and VFS Global
JPETS tuberculosis screening	Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare JPETS program
Address and residence-card procedures	ISA and municipal office
National Health Insurance in Osaka	Osaka City
Extra school documents and fees	Osaka Naniwa Japanese Language School

COE EVIDENCE

Financial Capacity and Bank Balance

Legal and administrative basis

The Student COE application requires the planned method of support for tuition, living expenses and rent, the average monthly support amount, remittance method, and each sponsor's identity, occupation and annual income. ISA document checklists for specified Japanese-language-school cases require an original bank balance certificate and evidence explaining the past 1 year of fund formation.

Official evidence standards

- The bank account must be with a bank recognized or authorized by the relevant national government or central bank.
- Fund-formation evidence may include transaction statements, passbook copies and annual income certificates issued by a public authority.
- Where remittance is difficult, evidence explaining how funds will be moved may be required.
- ISA places importance on a sufficient funding plan to prevent financial hardship after entry.
- Forged evidence or a temporary large deposit may cause doubt about whether the applicant genuinely intends to maintain proper Student status.

What the official sources do not provide

The reviewed national sources do not set one universal published minimum bank balance for every student. The necessary amount depends on tuition, study length, living costs, sponsor income, savings history and the facts of the case.

School-specific difference

The supplied one-page school preparation list asks for the past 1 year of fund formation and sponsor income/tax evidence. The longer school guide asks for 3 years of transaction and tax evidence. Treat 1 year as the base documented period and 3 years as an additional school review requirement when requested.

- ISA Class I Japanese-language institution COE checklist
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/content/001403366.pdf>
- ISA notes on financial-support evidence
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/content/001461504.pdf>
- Student COE application form, applicant pages
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/content/001460076.pdf>
- Official Financial Sponsorship Statement format
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/content/001366747.pdf>

OCTOBER 2026 POLICY CHANGE

Japanese Ability Rules

For students planning to enter Japanese-language institutions from October 2026, ISA revised the evidence used to confirm basic Japanese ability. A study-history certificate showing 150 hours by itself is no longer sufficient for the affected COE applications. An accepted test certificate or an objectively documented school interview is required, subject to the published exceptions.

Why the passed interview matters

The school may use an objectively conducted interview to confirm A1-equivalent ability if it documents the questions, answers and selection standard in the manner required by ISA. Passing a general admissions interview does not automatically prove that the immigration documentation standard has been satisfied, so the school must confirm what evidence it will submit.

- ISA: Partial revision for applicants entering Japanese-language institutions
https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/10_00258

NEPAL

JPETS Tuberculosis Screening

Nepal is a target country under Japan Pre-Entry Tuberculosis Screening. The mandatory submission date for a TB Clearance Certificate when applying for a COE or visa was 23 June 2025. Only designated panel clinics can issue the certificate for this program.

- Check the official clinic list immediately before booking.
- Make sure the name and passport details on the certificate are correct.
- Submit at the COE or visa stage directed by the school and authorities.
- Check certificate validity against the chest X-ray date and planned submission/entry timeline.
- **JPETS English portal and Nepal clinic list**
<https://jpets.mhlw.go.jp/>
- **JPETS Nepal information in Nepali**
<https://jpets.mhlw.go.jp/ne/emi/>
- **JPETS implementation guideline**
https://jpets.mhlw.go.jp/doc/r6guideline_for_jpets_eng.pdf

NATIONAL AND NEPAL PROCEDURES

COE, Visa and Entry

Certificate of Eligibility

- The COE is issued by a regional immigration authority and supports smoother visa and landing examination.
- A COE does not guarantee visa issuance or entry.
- The standard validity period is 3 months from issuance for the landing application.
- Electronic COE presentation and printed copies are accepted under current procedures.

Visa application in Nepal

- Ordinary applications are submitted through VFS Global, not directly to the Embassy, except specified diplomatic/official cases.
- The Embassy states a typical 6-working-day period after VFS submission when there are no deficiencies.
- Detailed examination may take 1 to 2 months, and student-intake periods can have appointment congestion.
- The current VFS language-school checklist must be rechecked before submission.
- ISA COE application procedure for Student status
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/applications/procedures/16-1.html>
- ISA immigration and residence examination Q&A
https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/applications/guide/kanri_qa.html
- MOFA general visa: Student
https://www.mofa.go.jp/j_info/visit/visa/long/visa6.html
- Embassy of Japan in Nepal: visa information
https://www.np.emb-japan.go.jp/itpr_ja/11_000001_00824.html
- VFS Japan Visa Application Centre in Nepal
<https://visa.vfsglobal.com/one-pager/Japan/Nepal/english/>
- Current VFS long-term stay and language-school checklist
<https://visa.vfsglobal.com/one-pager/Japan/Nepal/english/pdf/long-term-stay-student-employment-dependent-and-other.pdf>

IMMIGRATION CONTROL ACT ARTICLE 19(2)

Part-Time Work

Student status does not itself authorize paid work. Prior permission for activity outside the status of residence is required. The legal procedural basis published by ISA is Article 19(2) of the Immigration Control and Refugee Recognition Act.

Rule	Practical meaning
Prior permission	Do not begin training or paid shifts until permission has been granted.
28 hours per week	The combined total across every employer and job must stay within 28 hours.
Long school vacations	During a long vacation designated by the educational institution, the general limit is 8 hours per day.
Prohibited businesses	No work in or connected with adult-entertainment businesses or prohibited premises, even for cleaning or kitchen duties.
Enrollment condition	The comprehensive Student permission applies while the person is properly enrolled and carrying out the main study activity.
Study priority	Work must not interfere with attendance or study and cannot be presented as the plan for covering all tuition and living costs.

Multiple jobs

The 28-hour limit is not per employer. Add together every paid hour from every workplace. Keep schedules, wage statements and contracts so the total can be checked.

- ISA: Permission to engage in activity outside status
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/applications/procedures/16-8.html>
- ISA: Detailed conditions and prohibited activities
https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/applications/guide/nyuukokukanri07_00045.html
- ISA: Immigration and residence examination Q&A, including Student work hours
https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/immigration/faq/kanri_qa.html
- ISA: Guidance for new entrants
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/support/guidance/index.html>

AFTER ARRIVAL IN OSAKA

Residence Card, Address and Health Insurance

Residence card and address

Eligible mid- to long-term residents arriving at Kansai and other designated airports generally receive a residence card during entry procedures. After fixing a place of residence, the new resident must notify the municipal office within 14 days, bringing the residence card or the passport when the card will be issued later.

National Health Insurance

Foreign residents registered in Osaka City who are not covered by an excluded category or another applicable public health-insurance system generally become National Health Insurance members. The insured person normally pays 30% of covered medical costs for the standard student age group. Premiums are determined by the municipality and can change based on income and household circumstances.

School premium figure is only an estimate

The supplied school guide estimates about JPY 2,000 per month in the first year. This is not a guaranteed legal rate. The ward office's assessment and notices control the actual amount.

- ISA: Guidance for new entrants and 14-day address notification
<https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/support/guidance/index.html>
- ISA: Residence-card issuance at airports including Kansai
https://www.moj.go.jp/isa/publications/faq/newimmiact_4_port-city.html
- Osaka City: National Health Insurance
<https://www.city.osaka.lg.jp/fukushi/page/0000369744.html>

FOR AGENCIES

Source Control and Update Checklist

Before each intake	Check
School course and fees	Obtain the current school guide, invoice, deadline and refund conditions.
COE document rules	Open the current ISA Student-status and Japanese-language-institution pages.
Japanese ability	Check whether the October 2026 revision applies to the planned entry.
JPETS	Check mandatory dates, panel clinics and validity guidance for Nepal.
Visa	Open the Embassy of Japan in Nepal and VFS pages; download the current checklist.
Part-time work	Give the student the current permission and prohibited-work rules before departure.
Local setup	Confirm Osaka ward-office and health-insurance procedures for the actual address.

Document hierarchy

For the individual case, follow the latest written request from the school or authority. If a school instruction is stricter than the general official checklist, label it as a school submission requirement rather than describing it as a universal statute.

Reference date: 28 August 2026. Web pages and checklists should be reopened before each submission because requirements may change.